

JAMES H.G. JONES

PRODUCT LEAD: GLOBAL PRIVACY, TRUST & SAFETY | ML / AI SOLUTIONS

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Product leader with a **15-year career spanning Google and TikTok** — from ad sales and solutions consulting through product marketing to **7+ years leading product management** across advertising, privacy, safety, and compliance for **tens of millions of users globally**. Consistent track record of **large-scale revenue impact** across ML/AI-powered advertising and user protection products. Hires, develops, and mentors PMs and drives cross-functional execution across Engineering, Legal, Policy, and Design. Known for **turning regulatory requirements into product strategy** — building scalable systems that satisfy compliance while driving user and business outcomes in highly challenging environments.

EXPERIENCE

TikTok

12/2023 – Present

Lead Product Manager, User Privacy — San Jose, California

- **Defined and executed a multi-year product roadmap for youth safety and content moderation:** improved safety for tens of millions of under-18 users globally and strengthened TikTok's long-term regulatory positioning, delivering across three product areas — parental controls, kids-only mode, and age-based feature access.
- **Led product strategy and execution for Australia's under-16 social media ban:** established the regulatory response framework for the ban, running workshops and sprints with stakeholders to shape the strategy and develop realistic product options for executive decision, then driving delivery.
- **Transformed Kids Mode US content pipeline:** tripled video approval rates via ML-based optimization while reducing cost-per-approved-video by **~70%**. Reduced fraudulent registrations by up to **80%** through security improvements that blocked bot attacks. Created a multi-market expansion roadmap for global rollout, including a rapid-launch playbook for new countries.
- **Defined long-term platform strategy for age transition:** increased the speed and overall share of teens adopting direct messaging, public accounts, and other settings without weakening safety protections, designing a system that enables tens of millions of teens to safely access broader platform features as they turn 16 and 18.
- **Delivered patent-pending parental controls over user blocking:** met Ireland's online safety requirements by launching a new blocking mechanism, coordinating **85+ people** across Legal, Trust & Safety, Engineering, UX, Compliance, and others.
- **Launched a data portability system:** recognized as best-in-class by European regulators and delivered with **zero escalations**, enabling approved external developers to request and export TikTok data through a solution that balanced system scalability with cost to build and speed, within tight deadlines.
- **Hired and mentored PMs across multiple levels:** strengthened the team through hands-on mentoring of junior staff in execution and stakeholder management, and developed interns who exceeded their goals and successfully delivered product specs through executive review.

TikTok

04/2021 – 12/2023

Lead Product Manager, Ads User Privacy — Mountain View, California

- **Architected TikTok's integrated privacy control strategy and built the resulting user data control suite:** a unified back-end and front-end system meeting multiple legal and user needs (**GDPR in Europe, CCPA/CPRA in California, and the EU Digital Services Act**), enabling users to review and clear the activity used to target them, opt out of individual advertisers, and delete data shared by third parties.
- **Rebuilt TikTok's global ad labeling system:** replaced a fragmented approach with consistent labels in every region and Digital Services Act-mandated commercial content disclosure for creators, while **improving ad viewability** and protecting revenue, by aligning Product, Engineering, Legal, Trust & Safety, and go-to-market teams.
- **Launched Limited Data Use to meet California's CPRA and equivalent state privacy laws:** delivered on deadline across all advertising data pipelines, designing a reusable architecture and auditing the handling of personally identifiable information across those pipelines to identify and close compliance gaps.
- **Identified and fixed a major user data export bug:** avoided potential regulatory exposure by running rapid product and engineering sprints to ship a hotfix, after an infrastructure review showed exports under-reporting third-party data across a high daily volume of user download requests.
- **Launched TikTok's anti-discrimination advertising policy:** drove **over 95%** advertiser acceptance ahead of the enforcement deadline, protecting ad revenue, by building in-product certification across UI, API, and SDK advertiser flows as a condition of continuing to run campaigns.

Google

05/2019 – 04/2021

Product Manager, Display Ads Automation — San Francisco, California

- **Launched a tagless remarketing approach** for small-business campaigns, closing the remarketing gap caused by tag-setup complexity — taking remarketing list coverage in affected ad campaigns from **8% to 95%**.

- **Delivered an automated product feed tool** from zero to beta, estimated to unlock **\$230M annual revenue** by enabling small businesses to run dynamic ads without manual setup.
- **Took the ML-powered customer acquisition product to public launch at Google Marketing Live**, integrating the product conceived in the role below into Google's flagship shopping campaigns for retail advertisers.

Google

Product Marketing, Display Ads Targeting — San Francisco, California

12/2016 – 05/2019

- **Drove go-to-market for Google's audience targeting suite** across display and video platforms, growing the portfolio toward **\$1B** through adoption initiatives, performance tracking, and sales enablement programs.
- **Conceived and championed an ML-powered customer acquisition product** from idea through to **\$135M annual revenue**, successfully driving alignment across business and engineering to launch the product.
- **Created Google's definitive ML audience targeting narrative** — the go-to sales resource explaining how machine learning powers ad targeting — used by global sales teams and presented at executive summits with major enterprise advertisers.

Google

Product Marketing, Greater China & South Korea — Shanghai, China

07/2014 – 12/2016

- **Led the region to #1 globally** in display ad optimization by training regional sales and technical teams and working directly with top advertisers, ultimately doubling product ads coverage to improve client return on ad spend.
- **Created a standardized new-market launch process for product ads** that sped up entry into countries not yet supported, and sourced a feed translation and ingestion tool after identifying feed data quality gaps — both piloted locally and later adopted globally.
- **Doubled a top e-commerce advertiser's weekly ad spend to \$200K within a year** through ad optimization and policy negotiations that increased eligible ad inventory by up to **70%**, making the account the region's largest dynamic remarketing spender.

Google

Solutions Consultant — London, UK

07/2013 – 07/2014

- **Built a scalable feed optimization program** that delivered double-digit improvements in click-through rate, ad spend, and return on ad spend across enterprise clients; created templates adopted by the broader solutions consulting team.
- **Managed technical implementations of Google's dynamic remarketing technology** across **25+ enterprise accounts** representing the majority of active UK client revenue — resolving ad serving, tagging, and integration issues, designing advanced setups that linked customer data to ad tracking across display and search, and training sales and account teams to run them.

Google

Account Manager, Ad Sales — London, UK

01/2011 – 06/2013

- **Won new business accounts** by coordinating cross-channel pitches spanning search, display, and mobile — closing six-figure deals through consultative, solution-led selling.
- **Became the go-to expert** on dynamic display advertising across the regional sales floor; trained peers and supported their client launches while consistently delivering on a core portfolio of top accounts.

EARLIER CAREER

07/2008 – 01/2011

Contract Project Manager — Freelancer

ADC College — Project Manager

TES Global — Sales Manager

EDUCATION

The University of Bath, UK — Master of Science (with Merit): Advanced Management Practice

The University of York, UK — Bachelor of Arts (Hons): Business Management

SKILLS

ADVERTISING	Ads Products & Monetization · Ad Policy & Enforcement · Brand Safety · Ad Labeling & Disclosure · Advertiser Tools & Controls · Audience Targeting · Campaign Automation · Privacy-Safe Targeting (Third-Party Cookie Phase-Out, Apple ATT)
REGULATORY & PRIVACY	GDPR · CCPA/CPRA · DSA · Global Privacy Regulations · Youth Safety Standards · Regulator Relations · Privacy Impact Assessments · PII Protection · Data Subject Rights & Data Portability
TRUST & SAFETY	Content Moderation · Trust & Safety Infrastructure · Privacy & Safety Systems · Fraud & Abuse Prevention · Age Assurance & Parental Controls
TECHNICAL & DATA	ML/AI Product Development · System Architecture · Product Analytics · A/B & Holdback Testing · KPI Definition
PRODUCT & GTM	Product Vision & Roadmaps · Prioritization · PRDs & Specifications · OKR & Goal Frameworks · Launch Planning · Sales Enablement · Positioning · Executive Presentations
LEADERSHIP	Team Leadership & People Management · Cross-Functional Collaboration · Executive Communication · Stakeholder Management · Influence Without Authority · Mentoring & Development